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December 1: The Case of the Angel's Wings

The Nether Wickham nativity play was nearly ready, and the cast arrived for rehearsal after tea. At 9:00 the Angel Gabriel came to be dressed and found her feathered wings gone from their hook. A little drift of white feathers led the search party to the Stage.

THE SUSPECTS

Mr. Fothergill, the stage carpenter

Motive: He wanted to build a grander pair of wings himself, with real hinges.

Miss Lacey, the costume lady

Motive: She wanted to mend the wings properly before the show, and nobody would let her.

Colin Barnes, the man playing Joseph

Motive: He hoped to be the one who found them and saved the show.

Mrs. Cattermole, the director

Motive: She wanted the angel in a simple halo instead, and nobody would listen.

PLACES: Kitchen, Church Porch, Stage, Vestry

OBJECTS: Costume Hamper, Coat Hanger, Laundry Bag, Cardboard Box

THE CLUES

1. A small angel saw the Coat Hanger in the Vestry, in the hands of whoever was there.
2. According to the verger, Colin Barnes never left the Church Porch.
3. The Costume Hamper carries no prints from Mr. Fothergill or from Mrs. Cattermole.
4. The organist saw Mrs. Cattermole carrying something: either the Coat Hanger or the Costume Hamper.
5. The muddy footprints in the Kitchen were left by whoever had the Cardboard Box.
6. Whoever was in the Church Porch had the Laundry Bag.

NOTES

DETECTIVE'S HUNCH

Before you start the grid, who do you suspect, and why? Check yourself at the end.

My hunch: _____ Was I right? Yes / No





December 1 Grid

X = no O = yes

	Kitchen	Church Porch	Stage	Vestry	Costume Hamper	Coat Hanger	Laundry Bag	Cardboard Box
Mr. Fothergill								
Miss Lacey								
Colin Barnes								
Mrs. Cattermole								
Costume Hamper								
Coat Hanger								
Laundry Bag								
Cardboard Box								

NOTES

It happened on the Stage. Who is the culprit, and what were they holding?

Culprit: _____ Holding: _____



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These pages are a free sample from
Advent Whodunits

The full book has 24 cozy Christmas mysteries,
one for every day from December 1 to 24.
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